

Nuts & bolts



A newspaper is a product ... like cornflakes. And for a long time, they've both been considered a traditional part of America's breakfast routine. Like cornflakes, though, newspapers often seem indistinguishable from one brand to another.

So how do you make your brand of cornflakes look more appealing to consumers? You take that yummy content, and you stick it in a very-much designed colorful box. Create a slick logo. Dream up an attractive promotion (*FREE WHISTLE INSIDE!*) or lift out some catchy phrase (*High-fiber nutrition with real corn goodness*) to catch the eye of passing shoppers.

Finally, you stick in all the extras that are required to be there—ingredients, the date, the company website address—as neatly and unobtrusively as you can.

All that holds true for news publications, too. And in this chapter, we'll examine the graphic nuts and bolts used to assemble newspapers: logos, flags, bylines, decks, teasers, liftout quotes and more. We'll explain how to label and connect related stories. How to break up deep columns of gray text. And how to add graphic devices that sell stories.

In other words, how to pack more real corn goodness into every bite.

CHAPTER CONTENTS

- ▶ **The flag:**
Examples of different newspaper nameplate styles146
- ▶ **Logos & sigs:**
How to design headers, logos, sigs and bugs to label regular and special features 147
- ▶ **Liftout quotes:**
Using quotations as a graphic element within text150
- ▶ **Decks & summaries:**
How to size them, where to dummy them and other design guidelines152
- ▶ **Bylines:**
A look at different formats both for news stories and for special pages154
- ▶ **Credit lines:**
Options for crediting photographers and illustrators155
- ▶ **Spacing:**
Guidelines for aligning story elements and margins on a typical page156
- ▶ **Rules & boxes:**
Guidelines for using them both functionally and decoratively157
- ▶ **Refers, teasers & promos:**
Guiding readers to stories scattered throughout the paper158
- ▶ **Breaking up text:**
Using subheads, initial caps and dingbats to break up long legs of text159
- ▶ **Jumps:**
Guidelines for jumping stories smoothly from one page to another 160

The flag

Let's begin at the top of Page One, with one of journalism's oldest traditions, the flag. Though newspapers have tried boxing it in a corner, flipping it sideways or floating it partway down the page, most papers choose the simplest solution: anchor the flag front and center to lend the page some dignity.

(Flags, incidentally, are often mistakenly

called "mastheads." But a masthead is the staff box full of publication data that usually runs on the editorial page.)

Student publications often update their flags every few years, while editors at larger, more traditional newspapers are less inclined to fiddle with them (in part because repainting delivery trucks and reprinting stationery gets expensive). They believe that

flags should evoke a sense of tradition, trust, sobriety—and indeed, some Old English flags look downright religious.

But others argue that flags are like corporate logos and should look fresh. Bold. Innovative. Graphically sophisticated.

Examine the sampling of flags below. What clues do you think they offer to their papers' personalities?

UT
San Diego

**USA
TODAY**

**The Gainesville
Sun**

Newspaper of the Central Coast • SanLuisObispo.com

THE TRIBUNE

StarTribune

What's essential in a flag? The name of the paper. The city, school or organization it serves. The date. The price. The edition (*First*, *Westside*, *Sunrise*), if different editions are published. Some papers include the volume number—but though that may matter to librarians, readers rarely keep score.

Different flags, different choices

Some papers float their flag in white space to give it prominence. Others add elements such as text or visuals to fill the space near the newspaper's name. This unit of elements across the top part of the page is known by different names: the promo, skybox or ear, to name a few. Papers stick a variety of items in this spot: weather reports, slogans ("All the News That's Fit to Print") or teasers promoting features inside the paper.

*** Free app**
Available for download on your iPad, iPhone or Android

Orlando Sentinel
OrlandoSentinel.com
mobile.OrlandoSentinel.com

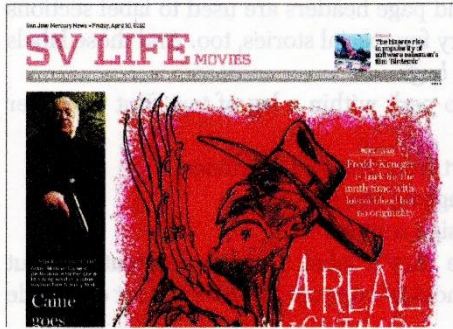
WEATHER
79°/61°
(today/tonight)
Stray coastal shower.
Forecast, B10

INDEX
Comics.....D16
Deaths.....B8
Movies, TV..B4
Opinion.....A14
Sports.....C1
Wall St.....A18

SPORTS
UCF shocks UConn
UCF rallies to a 68-63 win over No. 4 Connecticut — the highest-ranked team the Knights have ever beaten. C1, C2

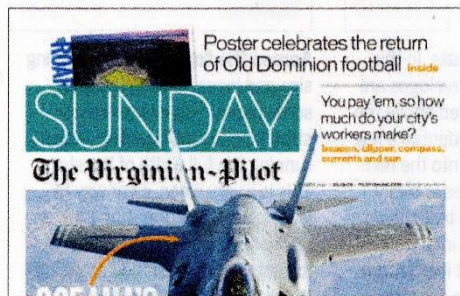
ORLANDOSENTINEL.COM/VARSITY
High-school-football playoffs
Timber Creek17
Olympia6
Mainland23
Winter Haven..20
Tampa Plant....49
Dr. Phillips.....13
East Ridge3
Evans2

Sports, C1, C9



Section-front personality The treatment of these signposts for the different sections of a newspaper can vary greatly—from the subtle to a more in-your-face style.

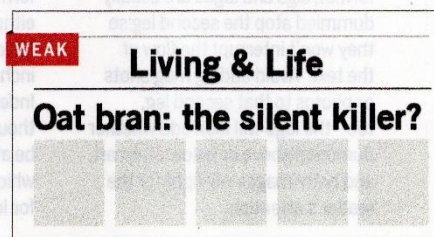
Section-front treatment In some newspapers, the section front logo designs are visually consistent throughout the paper. In other papers, each one has its own distinct flavor. Either way can work, but if the section front logo presentations are dramatically different from one another, they may not look like they are part of the same publication. In *The Virginian-Pilot*, the large, light-weight section front headers help tie together all the different parts of the paper:



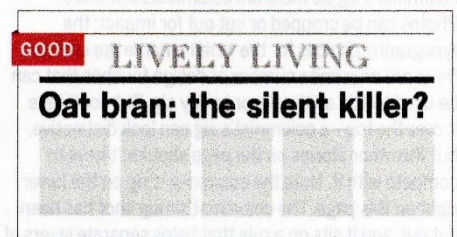
STANDING HEADS AND SECTION LOGOS As you travel through a newspaper, you pass signposts that tell you where you are. Some are like big billboards (“Now entering LIVING”). Others are like small road signs (“Exit here for Movie Review”).

Every paper needs a well-coordinated system of signposts—or, as they’re often called, *headers* or *standing heads*. Just as highway signs are designed to stand apart from the scenery, standing heads are designed to “pop” off the page. They can use rules, decorative type, fancy screens or reverses—but it’s essential that their personalities differ from the ordinary text, headlines and cutlines they accompany.

Compare, for example, these two headers (also called section *flags* or *logos*):



No contrast This section logo uses the same typeface as the headlines—they’re both the same size and weight, too. Nothing sets the top line apart from the headline of the day’s news—so nothing pops off the page. The overall effect is static. To help the reader navigate through the page, the look of the logo and the headlines must be clearly defined.



Clear contrast Here, the section logo looks entirely different from the headline below. The logo is made up of an all-caps serif font that feels light and airy. There’s also a screen of black, with a thin drop shadow. The main headline is a thicker sans serif font. The two lines are separated by a thick rule that sets apart the section head from the rest of the page.

A *logo* is a title or name that’s customized in a graphic way. Logos can be created with type alone, or by adding rules, photos or other art elements.

Section logos, like those above, help departmentalize the paper. In small tabloids, they should appear atop the page to signal major topic changes (from Features to Opinion, for instance). Bigger broadsheets use section logos to label each separate section, often adding teasers to promote what’s inside.

Some newspapers use standing heads to label the content on every single page. Others reserve that treatment for special themed pages (*Super Bowl Preview*) or investigative packages (*Guns in Our Schools: A Special Report*).

Either way, those added signposts guide readers most effectively when they’re designed in a graphic style that sets them apart from the “live” news.



OSCAR Coleman for 103 and a

Continued from page 102

Oscar Sim know they? a good foot they've got coached," coach Bill teams have secure Get titles. "I let away how he. It's got friendly rivalry ever previous a "If it even we meet, it don't over w To me, this Coach's alike said t match-up i to prepare "It's proba est team w the regulat Oscar Staff J.C. Coleman measuring out our seat Coleman, 103 yards at said this at

LEE TOLLIVER

illustrations courtesy of Duane Kaver

WITH THE completion of the White Marlin Open and the Alice Kelly Biltfish tournaments, the bluewater tournament season is in full swing. The Pirate's Cove Biltfish Tournament concludes Friday and is followed by the Wine, Women and Fishing tournament this weekend and Virginia Beach Biltfish Tournament next week. Both events are staged out of Virginia Beach's Rouse Ball.

White big blue marlin are the premier fish in these events—except the WMO—the white marlin usually provides most victories. Aleutia, a Palm Beach, Fla., boat with several Virginia Beach anglers on board, won the WMO release division with eight white marlin and five blue marlin. Sea Note, a boat based in Kilaheo, Hawaii, N.C., took home \$126,377 for a third-place white marlin that weighed 791 pounds. In all, the 237 teams caught 807 white marlin in the Ocean City, Md., event. The species at one time was being considered for the endangered list and still is thought to be threatened, but numbers like those at the WMO are promising. The efforts at tournaments, where federal mandate requires the use of circle hooks, appear to be helping. Few fish are kept unless money is involved or they die in the fight.

White marlin usually aren't big by biltfish standards, with most averaging around 50 pounds. Fish up to 8 feet long aren't uncommon, and the world record is a 181-pound, 14-ounce fish caught off Brazil in 1979. The record probably won't be broken because most countries that host sportfishing are understanding the importance of conservation with biltfish.

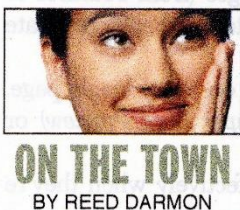
Non-obtrusive mug Here, the columnist's mug shot is half a column wide and runs alongside the first leg of text. The writer's name is presented in a simple and clean way: no shadows, decorative type or color. The presence of the other elements here—the headline treatment and the big fish—give this column a distinctive and recognizable look.

Mug choices There are as many ways to design a columnist's sig as there are columnists out there. Photos can be cropped or cut out for impact; the typography choices for the writer's name are endless; there are an infinite number of design touches that can be used to add a little flavor to any sig. But don't take it over the top—a columnist's sig can look distinctive, but the other stories on the page shouldn't have to compete with it. Note the columnist's sig on the lower right on this page. The columnist's mug shot has been cut out, and it sits on a rule that helps separate layers of information on what the column is about.

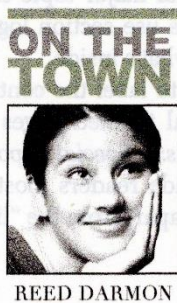


REED DARNON

On the Town



ON THE TOWN
BY REED DARNON



REED DARNON

As we've just seen, section logos and page headers are used to label sections and pages. But labels are necessary for special stories, too. And those labels for stories are called *logos*, *sigs* or *bugs*.

Story logos are usually small enough to park within a leg of text. But whatever their size, they need to be designed with:

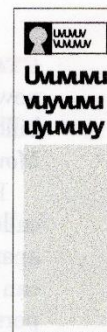
- ▶ A graphic personality that sets them apart from text and headlines;
- ▶ A consistent style that's maintained throughout the paper; and
- ▶ Flexible widths that work well in any design context.

It's important to dummy logos where they'll label a story's content without confusing its layout—which means they shouldn't disrupt the flow of text or collide with other elements.

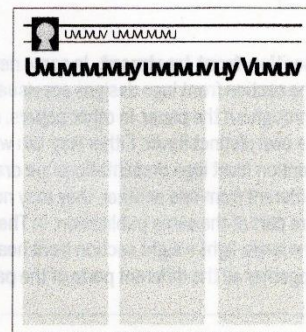
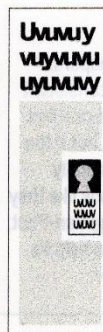
Here are some of the most common ways to dummy logos with stories:



Multi-column layouts In this format, sigs and logos are usually dummied atop the second leg so they won't interrupt the flow of the text. Avoid adding mug shots or photos to that second leg, too—the logo will look odd whether dummied above or below other art, and both images will fight for the reader's attention.



Vertical layouts In this format, sigs and logos are either dummied above the headline or indented a few inches down into the text. Indenting logos is tricky, though, since text should be at least an inch wide—which doesn't leave room for long words in a logo.



Across the top Instead of placing sigs and logos down in the text, some papers use headers that stretch above the headline, usually running the full width of the story. This is a very clean, clear way to label special features, but it takes up more space than the other formats—and doesn't do anything to break up gray legs of text.

COLUMN LOGOS Column logos are a way to label special writers, those regularly appearing personalities whose names and faces deserve prominent display. These logos (also called *photo sigs*) are usually reserved for writers whose columns are subjective, opinionated or humorous—and whose columns hopefully become a regular reader habit. (To support that habit, then, it's important to dummy the column in the same style and the same place each time it runs.)

Column logos usually consist of:

- ▶ The writer's name.
- ▶ The writer's likeness (either a photo or a sketch).
- ▶ A catchy title: *Dear Abby*, *Screen Scene* or *On the Town*.

Monday: Q&A Tuesday: Transportation Wednesday: Q&A Thursday: Watchdog Friday: Transportation Saturday: Good People Sunday: Transportation

Ask Us

Page A2 // December 15, 2011 // The Huntsville Times

The Times' Watchdog Team

CHALLENGE STEPHENS is the Government and Politics Editor // challen.stephens@huntsville.com

Watchdog

Continued from page A1

"I don't know how she has reached whatever

paign occurred when Brooks signed a Tea Party pledge to ban all earmarks.

Road watch

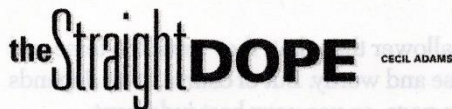
Live traffic alerts:

The Times and Lite 96.9 have teamed up to provide live traffic coverage. Tune to 96.9 for updates or visit al.com/alerts to sign up for email or text alerts.

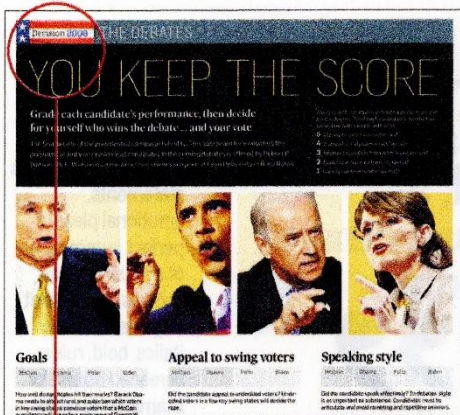
Huntsville

Balch Road is closed to through traffic between U.S. 72 and Capshaw Road to replace a bridge over Knox Creek. The project is expected to last until next summer.

Crews are working in the eastbound lanes on the Governors Drive widening project between Bassett and Gallatin streets until mid-February.



Effective labeling The Athens NEWS, a bi-weekly tabloid-sized newspaper in Ohio, runs many columns on divergent topics. Some of the columns originate from staff writers, and others—like News of the Weird—are syndicated. The challenge for the designer here is to create a series of sigs that are unique to each column—and still look like they are part of the same publication.



Election time, again Elections are scheduled far in advance, so there shouldn't be any last-minute scrambling to create an election logo—something that will run repeatedly throughout the election season. At a glance, readers will have no doubt what these stories are about on this front page of The Sun-Sentinel. Here, a small logo runs at the top of this page, to signify what this overall package is about. This logo can easily be tucked into any story anywhere in the paper.

SIGS AND BUGS Column logos promote the personalities of writers. Sigs and bugs, on the other hand, identify topics. They're a functional yet decorative typographic treatment that's used to label:

- Briefs and non-standard news columns (*Business Notes*, *People*, *World Roundup*);
- Opinion pieces that need to be distinguished from ordinary news stories (*News Analysis*, *Movie Review*);
- Regularly appearing features (*NFL Notebook*, *Action Line!*, *Money Matters*, *Letters to the Editor*).

At some papers, there's even a trend toward labeling more and more stories by topic (*City Council*, *Medicine*, *Tennis*). That's difficult to do consistently throughout the paper—quick, what's a one-word label for a story about two jets that nearly collide?—but when it works, it's a helpful way to guide busy readers from topic to topic.

Other papers use sigs that refer to stories on other pages or include fast facts (as in that bottom movie review sig at right).

Sigs can be designed in a variety of sizes and styles, adding rules, screens or graphic effects to catch readers' eyes. But every paper should use a consistent graphic treatment for all its logos. That means the style you use for POP MUSIC should also be appropriate for OBITUARIES.

SERIES LOGOS Series logos are a way to label special packages (a five-day series on *Racism in the Classroom*) or stories that will continue to unfold over an extended period (like *Election 2012* or *Revolt in Egypt*).

Series logos (called *icons* at some papers) usually consist of:

- A catchy title that creates reader familiarity;
- A small illustration or photo that makes the topic more graphic;
- Optional refer lines to other pages or to tomorrow's installment.

Logos are usually one column wide or indented into the text—and as these examples from The Detroit Free Press show, they come in a variety of styles:



MOVIE REVIEW

MOVIE REVIEW

movie review



Movie Review

MOVIE REVIEW

MOVIE REVIEW

Rise of the Planet of the Apes

★★★★

Starring: James Franco, Andy Serkis and Freida Pinto

Director: Rupert Wyatt

Motion Picture Rating:
PG-13 for frightening scenes of action and violence



Quotation mark styles These punctuation marks can be used as visual hooks on a page to draw attention to what someone said. These can be huge, colorful, or partially hidden behind type. Magazines frequently make the most of quotation marks—this venue is a great resource for collecting ideas.

"If I repent of anything, it is very likely to be my good behavior. What demon possessed me that I behaved so well?"

— Henry David Thoreau

"If I repent of anything, it is very likely to be my good behavior. What demon possessed me that I behaved so well?"

— Henry David Thoreau

Hanging punctuation Can you see the difference between above examples? No? Look again. Try taking a straight edge to the left side of the column. See it now? In the example on top, the quotation mark is aligned exactly along the left edge, and yet the quote looks indented. On the bottom, the quotation mark is hanging outside of this edge, so optically, it looks even with the rest of the text.

Why even bother with this nit-picky detail? With pull quotes that are larger in size, spaces are accentuated. So, without hanging them, alignment looks a little off.

(To get the quotation mark to hang in InDesign, select the appropriate text box, choose "Type" in the top menu, then choose "Story." Click on the button next to "Optical Margin Alignment." And, voilà!)

The surest way to make a monkey of a man," said Robert Benchley, "is to quote him." And a sure way to make readers curious about a story is to display a wise, witty or controversial quote in one of the columns of text.

As the examples here show, liftout quotes can be packaged in a variety of styles, enhanced with rules, boxes, screens or reverses. They go by a variety of names, too: *pull quotes*, *breakouts*, *quote blocks*, etc. But whether simple or ornate, liftout quotes should follow these guidelines:

▶ **They should be quotations.** Not paraphrases, not decks, not narration from the text, but complete sentences spoken by someone in the story.

▶ **They should be attributed.** Don't run "mystery quotes" that force us to comb the text for the speaker's identity. Tell us who's doing the talking. In many cases, it also helps to include the person's title, or even circumstances. For example, "John Doe, a neighbor who witnessed the crime."

▶ **They should contrast with the text type.** Don't be shy. Use a liftout style that pops from the page to catch the reader's eye—something distinctive that won't be mistaken for a headline or subhead.

▶ **They should average 1-2 inches deep.** Shallower than that, they seem too terse and trivial; deeper than that, they seem too dense and wordy. But of course, it all depends upon the quote and the way it's used on the page, so use your best judgment.

COMBINING QUOTES AND MUGS Words of wisdom are attractive. And when we see the speaker's face, we're attracted even more. That's why mug/quote combinations are among the best ways to hook passing readers.

Quotes with mugs can be designed to run boxed or unboxed, screened or unscreened. Whatever style you adopt, adapt it to run both horizontally (in 2- or 3-column widths) and vertically (in 1-column widths or indented within a column). Be sure the format's wide enough, and the type small or condensed enough, to fit long words without hyphenation.



"I'm an actress, a brand, a businesswoman. I'm all kinds of stuff."

Paris Hilton,
actress, brand and businesswoman

Quotes with style People say all kinds of things that are quotable: outrageous statements, emotional pleas, a perfect summing up of a situation. Use contrast in different ways—size, color, italics, bold, rules, screened boxes, for example—to make these quotes pop. With or without mugs, remember to **keep liftout quotes as typographically tidy as you can.** And use these sparingly: partial quotes, parentheses, ellipses. Avoid hyphenation and widows.

"So you're telling me that ... the phrase 'separation of church and state,' is in the First Amendment?"

— Christine O'Donnell,
Republican Senate nominee
in 2006, 2008 and 2010



Troubleshooting

Q In magazines, I see logos and liftout quotes used with smaller type than in newspapers. How small can those things be?

Many magazines try to push the limits of miniaturization. And because their presswork is so pristine and accurate, they can successfully run type and photos much smaller than newspapers normally dare.



"How is it that George Washington slept in so many places but never told a lie?"

— BUD CLARK

But if you're crafty and careful, you can downsize your design components, too. Newspapers that use exotic grids (an 18-column broadsheet, for example) may need to create mug/quote combinations like the one at left—a mere 4 picas wide. But by cropping tightly and selecting condensed fonts

that read well at a smaller size, you can keep them both attractive and readable. The key is to maintain contrast between the pull quote and whatever is around it (whether it's text or white space).

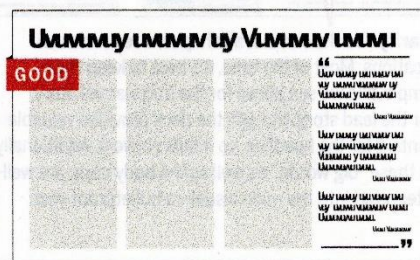
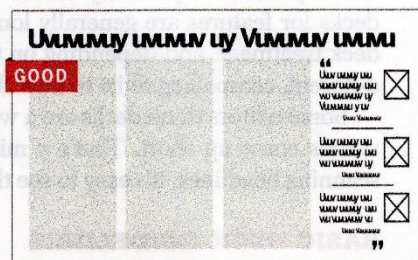
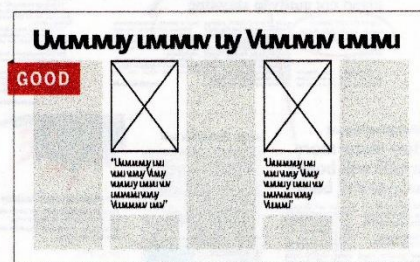
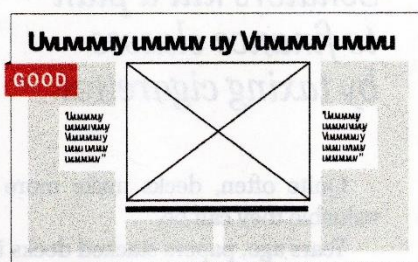
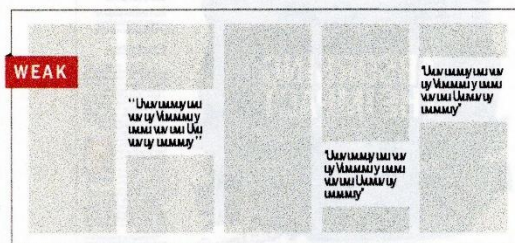
With small type, though, be cautious with the use of color. Registration problems (when the cyan, magenta, yellow and black—our CMYK—plates aren't hitting the paper in the same exact spot on the paper) could easily make a smaller-than-usual quote unreadable. (And if you use really thin rules in color around that quote, you could be asking for some reproduction trouble.)

Remember, the older your readers, the more sight-challenged they most likely are. Student newspapers will be able to miniaturize logos and liftout quotes more successfully than mainstream newspapers.

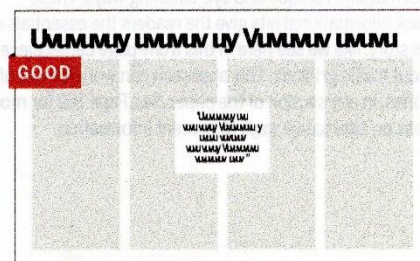
GUIDELINES FOR DUMMYING LIFTOUTS

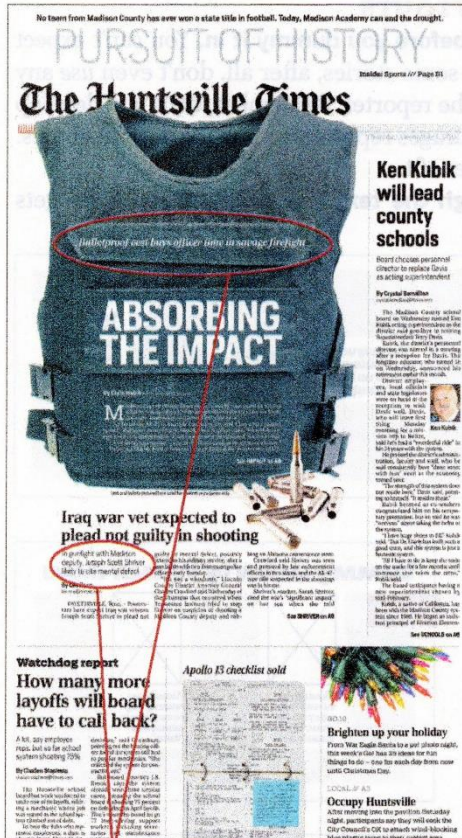
► **Be sure you have a quote worth lifting before you dummy it in.** You can't expect great quotes to materialize automatically—some stories, after all, don't even use any quotations. Read the story first. Or talk to the reporter. Remember, once you develop the habit of promoting great quotes, it encourages reporters to find more great quotes. As a result, both stories and readers will benefit.

► **Don't sprinkle liftouts randomly through the text just to kill space.** That gets distracting. For maximum impact and better balance, dummy quotes symmetrically (below, left). Or create a point/counterpoint effect with two mugs (below, right). Or combine multiple quotes into an attractive package, with or without mug shots (below).

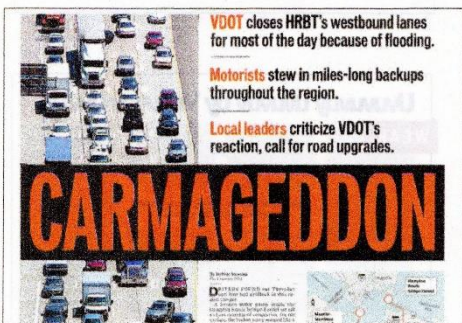


► **Never force readers to read around any 2- or 3-column impediment.** Text that hops back and forth like that gets too confusing (right). Use 2-column liftouts only at the top of the text (below). One-column liftouts usually aren't quite as confusing, but as an alternative, you might try indenting an area for the liftout, then wrapping the text around it (below right).





Clarity Decks come in all shapes, sizes and even locations. Most of the time, it's best to keep them simple, like we see above for the Iraq war vet story. For the lead story, though, the deck provides valuable context for the headline, so it falls above it. Additionally, all these "big words," as well as the body copy, are well-integrated into the main visual—a bulletproof vest.



The essentials Lots of newspapers pull out deck-type information in unique and eye-catching ways. These quick informational hits give the readers the essentials of the story, like we see here in this front-page centerpiece about traffic gridlock. This approach can work for lots of stories, in any section of the paper. See Page 162 for more ideas on alternative ways to present information.

Imagine just being limited to using one, two or three words to "describe" a story in some unique way. Not an easy thing to do, and yet, one of the most persistent problems in all of newspapering is this very thing: The Headline That Doesn't Quite Make Sense on its own:

Schools bill falls

Copy editors are only human, usually, so headlines like that are inevitable. But one way to make headlines more intelligible—especially on important stories—is to add a deck below the headline to explain things further:

Schools bill falls

Senators kill a plan to finance classes by taxing cigarettes

Big enough to read This example uses a 36-point boldface condensed headline and an 18-point lightface deck. Decks are most effective in lightweight or italic faces that contrast with the main headline. In news stories, they're usually set flush left in the first leg of text.

Quite often, decks make more sense than headlines. Which shows you how valuable they can be.

Years ago, papers stacked decks in deep rows (see example, Page 28). Today, most use only one deck per story. Decks for news stories are often 3-4 lines (10-15 words); decks for features are generally longer (15-30 words). But there's a lot of variety in deck treatment, and depending on the story, a different deck style could help add a different, compelling twist to how the key story information is presented.

Some editors think decks are a waste of space and use them only as padding when stories come up short. That's a mistake. Since most readers browse the paper by scanning headlines, it's easy to see that a good head/deck combination adds meaning.

BASIC DECK GUIDELINES

- ▶ **Use decks for all long or important stories.** Remember, readers are more likely to plunge into a sea of text if they know in advance what it's about.
- ▶ **Use decks with all hammer or display headlines.** It's fine to dream up a clever feature headline like "Heavy Mental." But if you don't add a deck to explain what that means, readers may never decipher your cleverness.
- ▶ **Give decks contrast—in size and weight.** By sizing decks noticeably smaller than headlines, they'll be easier to write. They'll convey more information. And they'll look more graceful (as magazines discovered long ago). Though most papers devise their own systems of deck sizing, decks generally range from 14 to 30 points (or bigger), depending on the size of the headline they accompany.

For added contrast, most papers use either italic decks (with roman heads) or lightface decks (with regular or boldface heads). These combinations can also be reversed. Whatever your paper's style, it's important to set the deck apart—with both spacing and typography—from the headline and the text.

▶ **Stack decks at the start of the story.** Don't bury them in the text. Stick them in some corner or banner them across the full width of the page. Decks are functional, not decorative. Put them to work where they'll lead readers into the text—usually in the first leg (though in wider layouts, 2-column decks work fine).

In fancy feature layouts, you can be more creative. But that comes later.

Senators kill a schools bill plan to finance classes by placing a tax on cigarettes

By a 78-12 vote, the Ohio Senate rejects a plan to finance classes by adding a 10-cent tax on each package of cigarettes that are sold this year

COLUMBUS—Senate lawmakers ended any chance this year to raise revenue for public schools by increasing the tax on cigarettes.

A 10-cent tax hike on each cigarette package sold would have raised \$103.4 million in the first year, says Gov. Wendy Wallowman, a backer of the plan.

"Increased taxes on tobacco would not only help fund schools, they could also cut down on smoking rates and health care costs for everyone," Wallowman said at a press conference yesterday, just hours after the Senate vote.

A survey conducted last month found that a majority of Ohio voters were opposed

Please see **Tax**, Page A3

Overpowering There's an art to writing well-written, succinct headlines and decks. Sometimes, though, especially when stories are a little on the complex side, it's tempting to go overboard. What we see here is excessive—the equivalent of a run-on sentence. And the story's text is practically buried under the heap of words in the main headline and deck. There are other problems with this setup. Can you spot them? (Hints: See that hyphen? The bad breaks? Can you hear those repeating words?)

SUMMARY DECKS Some papers call them *summaries*. Others call them *nut grafts*. Either way, they're more than just downsized decks. They're a response to busy readers who say, "I'm in a hurry—why should I care about this story?" Hundreds of papers use them on many of their stories to distill the content of the text into about 20-30 words.

Quite often, decks make more sense than headlines. Which shows you how valuable they can be.

Schools bill falls

■ By a 78-12 vote, the Ohio Senate rejects a plan to finance classes by adding a 10-cent tax on each pack of cigarettes sold this year

More info Compare this headline/deck combination with the one on the facing page. Which offers more information at a glance? This example uses 12.8-point type. It begins with a dingbat to catch your eye (and to distinguish the summary from the text that follows).

The simplest way to create a summary is to write a longer-than-usual deck using smaller-than-usual type. But some papers try more creative approaches, both in the typography they use and in the way they highlight information (see below and left):

TAX PLAN DEFEATED:

By a 78-12 vote, the Ohio Senate rejects a plan to finance classes by adding a 10-cent tax on each package of cigarettes sold this year

Boldface lead-in This style is used to highlight key words—followed by more detailed summary material in contrasting italic type that's set at 12 points.

BRIEFLY

Background: To compensate for a projected \$3 million budget shortfall, the Ohio Senate debated a plan to finance classes by adding a 10-cent tax on each pack of cigarettes you buy.

What it means: The bill's 78-12 defeat may force Ohio to make drastic school budget cuts.

Contrast The word BRIEFLY in a reverse bar tops this off, then uses boldface words to break down parts of the story. The type is 9-point—which may be a bit small for a deck, but better for a pullout.

SUMMARY GUIDELINES

► **Don't rehash the headline and the lead.** Each element—the main headline, the summary and the lead of the story—should add something different to the reader's overall understanding. That means you should avoid repeating words or phrases. More importantly, it means writing those three elements as a single unit, with a flow of logic that leads the reader smoothly into the text. (In many newsrooms, the writer of the story contributes the wording for the headline and summary. That's an excellent way to maintain accuracy and avoid redundancy.)

► **Use conversational language.** Summaries should be complete declarative sentences in the present tense. Unlike traditional decks, summaries are couched in a reader-friendly, conversational style. As the examples above show, there's no need to eliminate articles (a, an, the), relative pronouns or contractions.

► **Don't be stodgy or pretentious.** Avoid obscure words or jargon. Simple words always work best—and short words will make hyphenation unnecessary.

► **Don't worry about bad breaks.** The traditional rules of headline writing don't apply here. A subject can be on one line, a verb on the next. Nobody will care if an infinitive is split between lines. But do avoid hyphenation and widows.

► **Feel free to improvise.** Many papers add quotes or mug shots to summaries, transforming them into graphic elements. How far is your paper willing to go?

Troubleshooting

Q How do you credit photos taken by someone's family, instead of a newspaper photographer? Or old file photos? Or digitally manipulated images?

When it comes to crediting stories and photos, one solution just won't work for every situation. (For instance, what's your byline wording for a wire-service story that's been expanded and reworked by two of your staff writers?)

In Chapter 8, we'll talk about how essential a good design stylebook is. And every staff's stylebook should contain an entry like the one below, adapted from The Richmond Times-Dispatch's outstanding 1996 stylebook, anticipating every variation of photo and graphic credits.

If your newspaper runs art and text from a variety of sources, you'll find a guideline like this handy for credit lines and bylines alike. Answering these questions in advance can save valuable time on deadline.

CREDIT LINE GUIDELINES

Staff photos: BENJAMIN BRINK/THE OREGONIAN

Photo illustration by TOM TREICK/THE OREGONIAN

Special event staff photos:

JOEL DAVIS/THE OREGONIAN, January 1998

Former staff photos: THE OREGONIAN

Reporter photos: KRISTI TURNQUIST/THE OREGONIAN

Freelance photos:

JOE SMITH/SPECIAL TO THE OREGONIAN

Syndicated material: ©WARNER BROS. RECORDS

Agencies/miscellaneous:

NATIONAL ARCHIVES

BBC PHOTOGRAPH LIBRARY

©1995 CAROL PRATT PHOTOGRAPHY

Family photo with date: 1993 FAMILY PHOTO

Family photo without date: FAMILY PHOTO

File photos: File photo, 1995

Wire photos: THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Wire graphics: THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

N.Y. TIMES NEWS SERVICE

Graphics staff: STEVE COWDEN/THE OREGONIAN

More than one artist:

DAN AGUAYO, MOLLY SWISHER/THE OREGONIAN

File graphic: THE OREGONIAN

Shared credit: Graphic by MIKE MODE,

Research by WALLY BENSON/THE OREGONIAN

Digitally altered images:

Illustration by RENE EISENBART/THE OREGONIAN,

source material by SUSAN UNDERHILL

Special staff project: BY THE OREGONIAN STAFF:

STEVE COWDEN, artist; RICHARD HILL, writer; MIKE MODE

and WERNER BITTNER, contributing artists

To reporters, bylines are the most important graphic element in the entire newspaper. What a shame, then, that readers rarely give bylines a glance as their eyes dart from the end of the headline to the start of the story.

It's necessary, though, to give credit where credit is due (especially when readers have complaints or questions about a story). Papers differ on byline policies, but most publications put reporters' names on stories of substance—that is, all stories more than about 6 inches long.

Bylines generally run at the start of the story in a style that sets them apart from the text: boldface, italics, one or two rules. The first line gives the reporter's name; a second line tells whether he or she writes for an outside organization (The Associated Press, for example), works as a freelancer (often labeled a "special writer" or "correspondent") or belongs on the staff (most papers run either the name of the paper or the writer's title).

Every newspaper should adopt one standard byline style. Some examples:

By MOE HOWARD
The Daily Planet

Larry Fine
THE DAILY PLANET FILM CRITIC

By CURLY HOWARD
curlyhoward@dailyplanet.com

Student newspapers sometimes use loud, eye-catching byline styles, perhaps as a bribe to lure reporters onto the staff. Screened, reversed or indented bylines can seem fun, but they call too much attention to themselves. Proceed with caution.

» BY HARPO MARX

By CHICO
MARX
.....
of The Times

BY GROUCHO MARX

For short sidebars or columns of briefs, credit is often given in the form of a flush-right tag line at the end of the text. As with bylines, these credit lines need spacing and typography that sets them apart from the text:

— The Associated Press

— Compiled from staff reports

Story by
STAN LAUREL

Photos by
OLIVER HARDY

Some papers run all bylines at the end of the story (and some even include the reporter's phone number or email address). At the start of the story, the logic goes, bylines just add clutter amid the headlines and decks; since writers' names are less urgent, they can come later.

On photo spreads and special features, newspapers often use a more prominent byline style to credit the writer, the photographer, or both. (Page designers, sad to say, rarely receive printed credit for their work.) These special credits are either parked at the edge of the design or indented into a wide column of text, like the Laurel and Hardy credit here.

describes the techniques she uses to force herself past the first idea and on to something more creative.

"There's some comfort in knowing I have, for example, Design A," Rose says. "Then it's easy to move past that, knowing I have at least something to show others."



Julia Rose

She tries to stay tuned to what she describes as those "happy accidents." "I might notice, for example, that as I move an object from one part of the page to another, I create some interesting juxtaposition that I hadn't noticed before," Rose says. "I follow my instincts as much as I can and pay attention to possibilities."

Seeing is believing, she believes, which

A byline for a mug shot? In a newspaper, oftentimes everyday mug shots have no credit lines. As you can see, there's really no room to jam a credit line anywhere near the photo, above. (At the very least, though, a mug shot should be identified with a name.)

Lower left corner Not many papers run credit lines in this spot. Instead, it's common to run the source line in the lower left corner—that's the line in a chart, map or diagram that tells the source of the data being used. Putting that information here (or inside the box) keeps it separate from other credit lines.



Source: Department of Redundancy Department

This is the cutline (or caption). Cutlines usually run a few points below the credit line and use a font that's bigger and bolder than the credit. The font size is often similar to the size used for the body copy.

STYLE, FUNCTION AND PLACEMENT Artwork, like stories, should be credited—whether the art comes from staffers, freelancers, wire services or library files. Different styles of credit lines serve different functions:

- ▶ For photos and illustrations, credit lines provide the name and affiliation of the photographer or artist who produced the image.
- ▶ For old, historic photos or maps, credit lines tell readers where the documents come from (i.e., The Bozoville Historical Society). Often, this info includes the date a photo was taken, which is necessary for any photo that could mistakenly be considered current.
- ▶ For charts or diagrams, an additional "source" line tells readers where the artist obtained the data that was graphicized. Citing such sources is just as important for artists as it is for reporters.
- ▶ For copyrighted material, credit lines provide the necessary legal wording (*Reprinted with permission of ... or ©2012 by ...*).

Not all publications credit all photos, however. For instance, most don't bother crediting run-of-the-mill mug shots. And publicity handouts—movie stills, fashion shots, glossies of entertainers—usually run uncredited, too (probably because editors resent giving away all that free publicity).

Most papers run credits in small type (below 7-point), in a font that contrasts with any cutlines nearby. Some papers still run photo credits at the end of their cutlines, like this: **Tokyo citizens scream in terror Friday as Godzilla destroys the city.** (Staff photo by Dan Gustafson.)

But that credit style isn't as effective as it could be. Ideally, there should be a clear distinction between cutlines and credit lines, just as there's a distinction between text and bylines.

Most papers run credit lines flush right, just a few points below the bottom edge of the art and a few points above the cutline. Some papers run them flush left. Some run them on top. Some have even tried running them sideways along the right edge, though that's difficult to read and tends to jam up against any adjacent leg of text. (When graphics use both a source line *and* a credit line, they should be dummied in two separate positions to avoid confusing readers.)

Below, you can gauge the effectiveness of each location:

Above the photo Some papers run credit lines here, flush right—though many readers habitually look for them below the photo, down around the cutline.

Next to the photo Many magazines run credit lines sideways or in the margins—but even if the type is tiny, it risks crowding into adjacent columns of text.

Below the photo Most papers run credit lines flush right, a few points underneath the image. Whatever you choose to do, keep it consistent—pick one position and run all credits there.

Friday, April 13, 2012 5B

SPORTS

The 9th inning



The Oregonian/STEVE NEHL

Come run as the Dodgers rallied in the ninth inning to win.

that pitcher threw,
we had us terrified
hole ball game."

— Sam Stone

renders." That was a signal
recognized, although it had
been passed between him and
Ruth. As it was,
the Babe had a great day, with two
home runs, a terrific long fly and two
bases on balls.

big bum if he hammers every ball in
the park into the North River."

And so, at Snyder's request, Bentley did pitch to Ruth, and the Babe drove the ball deep into right center; so deep that Casey Stengel could feel the hot breath of the bleacherites on his back as the ball came down and he caught it. If that drive had been just a shade to the right it would have been a third home run for Ruth. As it was, the Babe had a great day, with two home runs, a terrific long fly and two bases on balls.

Ump claims
new balk rule
may be unfair

By JACK KENNEDY
Sports editor

For the first time since the
American League instituted its
controversial new guidelines on

Every paper should standardize its spacing guidelines. Here, for example, is how one typical newspaper might space story elements on a typical page. The goal is to be consistent. Sometimes, though, with special stories or pages, you can break style and try something different.

SECTION LOGOS AND HEADERS

Above: Allow at least 3 points between logos and the folio line.

Inside: Maintain approximately 8-point margins between the logo type and the edge of the box.

Below: Allow about a pica and a half (18 points) between the page toppers and the content (headlines, photos, graphics, etc.) below it.

HEADLINES

Above: Allow about 18 points between the top of any headline on the page and other elements above it (such as page toppers or unrelated stories).

Below: Allow 6 points between descenders and text/photos below.

Roundups and briefs: When compiling packages of briefs that use small headlines (12- or 14-point), use tighter spacing—1 pica of space above the headline and 6 points below.

PHOTOS

Credit line: Allow 3 points between photos and credit lines.

Cutline: Allow 3 points between credit lines and cutlines. Allow 3 points between photos and cutlines if there's no credit line.

TEXT

Above: Allow 1 pica between cutlines and text.

Gutters: All vertical gutters that are at least 1 pica wide.

Graphic elements: Allow at least 1 pica between all graphic elements (liftout quotes, refers, etc.) and text.

Below: Allow 18 points between text and unrelated stories.

BOXED STORIES AND GRAPHICS

Margins: Allow 1 pica between outside rules and all headlines/text/photos.

BYLINES

Above: Allow 9 points between headline descenders and bylines.

Below: Allow 9 points between bylines and text.

When it comes to spacing in general, trust your eyes. If you find yourself asking other people, "Does this look too squished?" or "Is there too much white space here?"—the answer is probably "Yes!" What you think is a creative use of space might look like a mistake if you're not careful.

Fast-spreading fire kills 2 young sisters

Mother, 3-year-old daughter escape 2-story home in Stallings



Neighbors report hearing an explosion outside city center with under investigation



Kindred stranger seeks to honor soldier



Ruling boosts steroids probe in baseball

Nation's elite athletes of 100-MPH players might test to see

2nd bid for presidency raises heat on Edwards

Agitation helps, but failure in South directly

Agitation helps, but failure in South directly

Agitation helps, but failure in South directly

Agitation helps, but failure in South directly

Agitation helps, but failure in South directly

Maintain order This page from The Charlotte Observer shows how cutoff and column rules help organize story elements across the page—even keeping those top two headlines from butting.

A SAMPLING OF RULES AND BORDERS

Hairline

1 point

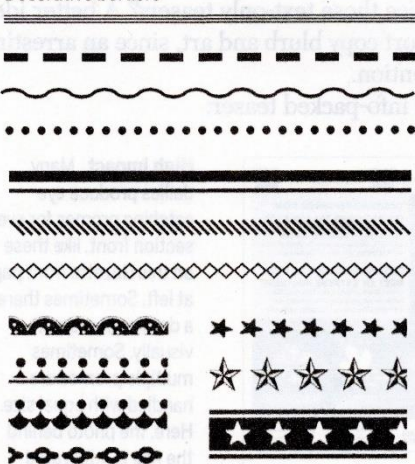
2 point

4 point

6 point

12 point

Decorative borders



This box is bordered with a plain .5-pt. rule.

Newspapers use rules both functionally (to organize and separate elements) and decoratively (to add contrast and flair). Notice, for instance, how the rules in this sig and byline are both functional *and* decorative:

NFL ROUNDUP

By ROBIN FOX

Bugle-Beacon staff writer

Rule thickness, like type size, is measured in points. That “NFL Roundup” sig uses a 4-point rule above the type and a 1-point rule below, while that byline uses a hairline rule (that’s the thinnest rule available). With so many widths to choose from, most papers restrict rule usage to a limited number of sizes—say, 1-point and 4-point: one thin, one thick.

Rules are most commonly used in the following ways:

- ▶ To build logos, bylines and other standing elements.
- ▶ To create boxes (for stories, graphics, ads, etc.).
- ▶ To build charts and graphs.
- ▶ To embellish feature designs and display headlines.
- ▶ To separate stories and elements from each other.
- ▶ To border photos.

Decades ago, newspapers used rules to separate all stories from each other. Some ran vertically in the gutters (column rules); others ran horizontally beneath stories (cutoff rules). That trend faded in the ‘60s, but it’s been making a comeback recently. As Harold Evans, editor of The Sunday Times in London, once said: “The most backward step, under the flag of freedom, has been the abandonment of column rules and cutoffs which so usefully define columns and separate stories.”

Running rules between stories is an effective way to control the flow of traffic. Still, many papers choose to run stories unrulled and unboxed, saving box treatments for big news packages, sidebars, stand-alone photos, etc. As we’ve said before, it’s best to box stories only if they’re special or if they need to be set apart from other stories on the page—not to compensate for butting headlines or poorly placed photos.

You may occasionally be tempted to use decorative rules or borders for special effects. But like other graphic gimmicks, it’s easy to use them clumsily or excessively—so go easy on the visual tricks.

Border mania

Thick frames and fat, noticeable shadows add a lot of noise and clutter, so avoid them—unless these “tricks” somehow accentuate the content of the story. In general, it’s best to use thin rules to build boxes and border photos. Simple is often cleaner and better.

Border boredom Rounded corners and decorative borders were stylish 30 years ago but can look corny and old-fashioned today. Gimmicks like these just call attention to themselves.

Border, unornamented Trim the visual excess and suddenly the message stands out more than the border itself. If you don’t have a good reason to do something, don’t do it.

Underscoring

Some designers try to jazz up labels, subheads or headlines by adding a rule (called an underscore) beneath them. It works for kickers and some display headlines (see Page 209), but usually not. Underlining words to add contrast can often look amateurish. On websites, though, underlined words offer links to other pages.

Troubleshooting

Q We run a row of small promos across the top of our front page every issue. Do readers actually notice those things?

Probably not. Why should they? It's a common problem: Day after day, issue after issue, newspapers run little postage-stamp-sized promos on their front pages. Too often, these promos advertise stories nobody's excited about. Too often, they use tiny, indecipherable images and short, indecipherable headlines. As a result, readers learn to ignore them. And those skyboxes turn into wallpaper.

The solution: Break out of the rut. Mix it up. Design new options that allow you to run three, two or just one dynamic image. Use cutouts. Reverse type. Remember: If you don't care about your promos, your readers won't, either.



The unexpected. Sometimes newspapers steer away from the more conventional photo treatment of a promo above the flag, as you can see in the examples above. As long as the treatment of the promo reflects the content of the story—and doesn't detract too much from the rest of the page (or the general style of the newspaper)—the unusual promo approach can work.

Throughout this book, we've cross-referenced much of the material in it by adding "learn more" references at the top of many pages. They're a handy way to show you where to turn for related information.

Newspapers need to cross-reference their stories, too. And they do that by using lines, paragraphs or boxes called *refers* (see examples right). Some refers are simple; others, with art, are more elaborate. Whatever style your paper uses, refers should:

► **Stand out typographically** from the surrounding text. That's why refers often include rules, bullets, boldface or italic type.

► **Be specific.** Refers should index all related items—on the TV page, the opinion page, wherever—not just say, "Other stories inside."

► **Be tightly written.** Refers are signposts, so they should simply point, not pontificate.

► **Be consistently positioned** every time they're used—i.e., above the byline, at the top of a column, at the end of the story—whatever is most appropriate and unobtrusive.

Refer line example

■ How Obama views the debt plan, **Page 5**.

Refer paragraph example

NAVY ALERT: Turkish destroyers were placed on red alert Wednesday as Iran launched its first nuclear submarine / **Page 4A**

Refer box (with art) example

INSIDE



- Why Murphy was forced to resign / **A5**
- Reaction from other board members / **A6**

TEASERS AND PROMOS A refer is a signpost that guides readers to stories inside the paper. A teaser is another kind of signpost—actually, it's more like a billboard. Where refers advise, teasers advertise. They say **BUY ME! NOW! HOT STORY INSIDE.**

The covers of most supermarket tabloids are loaded with titillating teasers. Most newspapers, by comparison, use a more subdued style for their teasers (also called *promos*, *skylines* or *boxcars*). Teasers are usually boxed in an eye-catching way at the top of Page One. Some are bold and simple:

SPOONER'S GRAND SLAM WINS IT FOR DODGERS/D1

But the question is: Do readers even notice those text-only teasers? A better idea is to combine a catchy headline phrase, a short copy blurb and art, since an arresting image is the surest way to grab readers' attention.

Here's an example of a highly visual and info-packed teaser:

[f gazette.com](http://gazette.com)
[@csgazette](https://twitter.com/csgazette)

NEWS 24 HOURS

MOBILE APP

IN OUT THERE

REGION'S NEW PARK GROWS UP

CHEYENNE MOUNTAIN PARK DRAWS MORE VISITORS AND BUSINESS, BUT THE PEAK STILL SEEMS OUT OF REACH.



COLORADO SPRINGS.COM

IT'S BEGINNING TO LOOK A LOT LIKE CHRISTMAS IN SPRINGS

Our photographers are capturing winter's magic, and you can see it all on the website.

OUTTHERECOLORADO.COM

MEET AN 'EXTREME HUNTER'S'

And see the region's biggest game warden. He's the only one who can take you to the edge of the wilderness.

The Gazette

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75 CENTS

WORLD ECONOMY

CENTRAL BANKS BOLSTER EUROPE

THURSDAY

December 3, 2013

CITY COUNCIL SUSPENDS DRILLING FOR 6 MONTHS

Emergency ordinance calls for a 'timeout' to study impact, regulations

DEAL OF THE DAY

Cafe Corte

Get 20% off your bill at Cafe Corte, the new cafe in the heart of downtown Colorado Springs. The cafe is open 7 a.m. to 5 p.m. weekdays, 8 a.m. to 4 p.m. weekends, and is open 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. on Tuesdays.

High Impact Many dailies produce eye-catching promos for every section front, like these on this Gazette front page at left. Sometimes there's a dominant promo, visually. Sometimes multiple promos are handled with equal size. Here, the photo behind the flag is integrated with the colors above it, and there's plenty of info about the paper's social media platforms.

Troubleshooting

Q Our paper is pretty small—usually it's fewer than 12 pages. Do we need to run an index?

Ask anyone who conducts newspaper market research: Readers *love* indexes, roundups, highlights—anything that tells them what you've got and where you've hidden it. Like diners in a restaurant, they want to see what's on the menu.

So even if you're a small paper, give your readers a guide to what's inside. And if an index is difficult to compile—if your paper is just a random collection of 15-inch stories—that may indicate you need to do a better job of organizing topics and providing a mix of briefs, lists, calendars and other regular features.



Guiding the reader Some newspapers, like the Boston Globe, use a short, cleanly designed index that direct readers to different sections of the newspaper. Above this index is what's called a rail, and on this page, it contains short blurbs (with page numbers) that describe stories inside.

Reading long columns of text is a tiring chore. But if you break up the gray with occasional subheads, initial caps or dingbats, you can better organize your material—and, at the same time, provide rest stops for the reader's eye.

SUBHEADS Subheads are the most common way to subdivide long stories (i.e., features or news analyses that run over 30 inches). They're often inserted every 8-10 inches, wherever there's a shift of topic or a logical pause in the commentary. Avoid inserting them at random (which won't help the reader's understanding of the material) or at the very bottom of a leg of type.

Subheads come in a variety of styles, but they're usually bolder than text type:

without first having his wife brought to see him; and they had sent an escort for her, which had occasioned the delay.

Under the guillotine

He immediately kneeled down, below the knife. His neck fitting into a hole, made for the purpose, in a cross plank, was shut down, by

Sutherland's trip at 7 p.m. Thursday at Pioneer Court-house Square. The program is free.

■ **Africa preview:** A slide presentation on Kenya and Tanzania will be shown at 10:30 a.m. Wednesday at Weststar Tour and Travel, 19888 S.E. Stark. The show is a preview of a February trip to desert

\$50 for Oslo, but a seven-day second-class rail pass can be bought for about \$70 at any rail station.

Hotel deals

The Fjord Pass program offers discounts on rates at 200 hotels. The pass costs \$10 and comes with a list of hotels offering discounts for

Bold This is a typical style for news subheads: bold type that is centered or flush left.

Bullet/colon This format is used to change topics in stories that consist of assorted bits and pieces.

Reverse label This reversed subhead helps organize catalog-style stories into sections.

INITIAL CAPS Initial caps are a classy way to begin features, columns or specially packaged news stories. They're also a decorative (though non-informational) alternative to subheads for breaking up long columns of text.

Be sure the large cap letter is neatly spaced and aligned, whether it's indented into the text or raised above it:

This is an example of a dropped initial cap. These caps are usually tucked into the first three or four lines of the text.

Here is a raised initial cap, also called a drop-cap, which sits above the first line of the text.

Even small graphics and sidebars can begin with initial caps to give the text extra typographic emphasis. Use too many of them, though, and it gets distracting and annoying.

DINGBATS Dingbat is the ridiculous-sounding term used to describe an endless assortment of typographic characters like these:



Most dingbats are too silly to use in a serious news publication. Some, however, are handy for relieving long legs of text (see example at right).

Others, like bullets (●) and squares (■), can help itemize lists within text. Remember, however:

- ▶ Use bullets or squares for three or more related items. Fewer than that, it looks odd.
- ▶ Keep bullet items short and punchy. Like this.
- ▶ Don't overdo it. Use bullets only for emphasis.

had left it in that instant. It was dull, cold, livid, wax. The body also.



There was a great deal of blood. When we left the window, and went close up to the scaffold, it was very dirty; one of the two men who were throwing water

Oat bran: Study proves it prevents heart attacks

Continued from Page 1A

Headline style This is a popular treatment for jump headlines. It treats the key word (or phrase) as a boldface lead-in, then follows with a lightface headline written in standard style. Since the key word is played so boldly, jump stories are easy to spot when readers arrive at the new page. To be effective, jump lines should be set apart from text by both extra spacing and type selection.

Oat bran Continued from Page 1A

Key word(s) This is another common style for jump headlines. It uses only the key word (or phrase) to catch readers' eyes, then adds a rule both for emphasis and to separate the text from any columns running above. Something to be aware of: If the jump headline does not clearly reflect the gist of the story, then readers might find it a bit difficult to initially locate this jump text on the page.

Study proves oat bran can prevent heart attacks

■ OAT BRAN, from Page 1A

Mixed styles This treatment is rather straightforward: a standard banner headline followed by boldface key words in the jump line. But is it obvious enough to readers that this is the oat bran story they're searching for? Some would argue that unless the jump headline boldly proclaims a key word or phrase, too many readers may get lost.

How about no jumps?

Surveys have shown that very few readers read stories after they jump. In fact, very few readers read more than the first few inches of most stories, whether they jump or not. They're impatient. They're distracted. The good news is that if readers care about a story, they'll follow it anywhere. And the really, really good news is that as a designer, you can help readers stay engaged by presenting stories in alternative ways. More on this on Page 162.

Continued from Page 99

and 4.

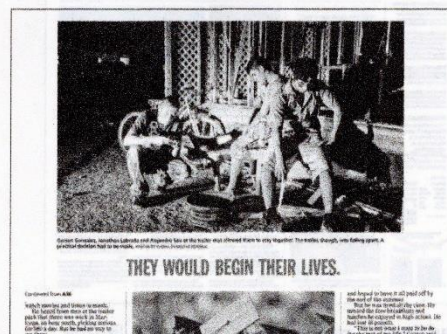
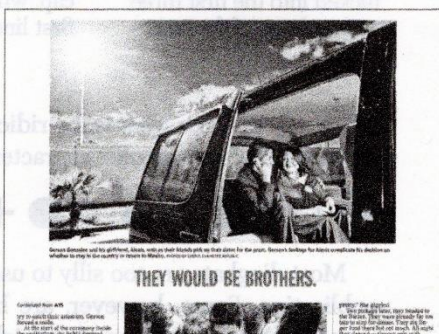
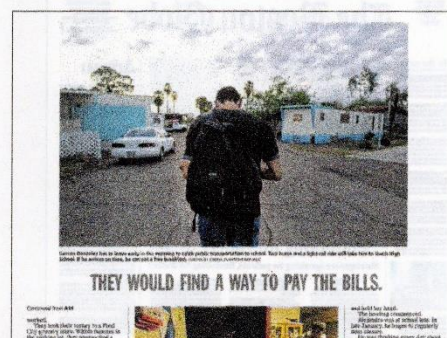
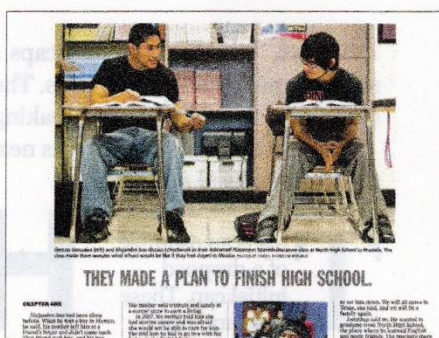
► **Avoid jumping orphans.** An orphan (sometimes called a widow) is a short word or phrase that's carried over to the top of a new column or page, like the first line in this column: "and 4." Orphans often look clumsy—like typographical errors, even if they aren't. And, as you may have just experienced, it's frustrating enough to reach the end of a column, then be told to turn to Page 160, then fumble around trying to find Page 160, then, when you get to Page 160, read something cryptic like "and 4"—at which point you realize you've forgotten the rest of the sentence back on Page 99.

And that's why readers dislike jumps.

► **Label jumps clearly.** Use typography to make it easier to find jumps. Run *continuation*, or *jump*, lines (the lines that tell you where a story is continued) flush right at the end of a column. Run *inside jump lines* (the lines that tell you where a story has been jumped from) flush left, since that's where your eye begins reading at the top of a column.

Another way is to give each jump a key word or phrase, then highlight it typographically. Suppose, for instance, you're jumping a story on oat bran. You could run a continuation line that simply says **Turn to Page 6**. But that's not too friendly—and it's not very informative. When readers get to Page 6, how will they spot the jump? You'd be wiser to say something like **See OAT BRAN, Page 6**. And when readers arrived at Page 6, they'd find a jump headline like one of these at left.

► **Give attention to the design of jumps.** Remember to package jumps as attractively as you'd package any other story. Many newspapers treat jumps like mandatory blocks of gray slop—the ugly leftovers. If there's time, add photos, create mug/quote blocks, pull out charts or maps or add a unique twist to jump heads, like you see below:



Jump lines for special stories Sometimes a newspaper will run a story, or a series of stories, that are different than the typical daily fare (for example, "special reports," or long-term investigative pieces). In those cases, breaking away from the paper's normal jump head style can work, as you can see in the examples above.

To summarize: Jumps will never be popular with readers. But if you can devise a clear, consistent format for packaging jump stories, readers will regard them as minor detours—not major roadblocks. And their benefits to designers (higher story counts and increased layout options on key pages) far outweigh the annoyance they cause readers.